



P56 · 40 PAGES, PRINTABLE + WRITING SPACE

Letters to Baby, a Pregnancy Keepsake Journal

A forty-page pregnancy keepsake journal. Thirteen prompted letters written across pregnancy to the unborn baby. Before-I-knew-you. The first appointment. The first kick. The name. What our family is like. What the world is like. What your other parent is like. The night before you came. The first time I saw you. Plus a "things I want to remember to tell you" running list, pocket pages for the ultrasound and the hospital bracelet, and space to keep.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

This journal is the lyrical one.

Most pregnancy planners track. Some plan. This one is for writing. To them. About them. About the year you are alive in while you wait for them. About the people around you who they have not met yet.

You can fill it in slowly. A letter a month, more or less. You can do it all in one Saturday afternoon at the kitchen table. You can leave letters blank that do not call to you. You can write extra in the margins. You can paste in things that are not asked for.

There is no right way to fill in this journal. There is only the way you do it.

When the baby is here, you can keep this on a shelf. You can give it to them when they are old enough to ask. You can read it on the morning of their wedding. You can pull it out the first time they break your heart, just to remember the version of yourself that wrote to them before they could refuse a hug.

Whatever you write becomes a thing they have. Or a thing you have. Either is the right answer.

With care, Maya

This is a keepsake journal, not a medical record. For specific concerns about the pregnancy, please follow your obstetric provider's guidance.

How to use this journal

- Print on good paper if you can. Card stock for the pocket pages.
- Write in pen, the way you would write a letter you intended to be read.
- The letters are loosely chronological but you do not have to do them in order.
- Some letters take five minutes. Some take an hour. Both are fine.
- The pocket pages can hold the actual ultrasound print and the actual hospital bracelet. Cut a small slit and tuck them in. Or scan them and print them in.

A small principle: do not edit yourself for the future reader. Write the honest thing. The kid does not need a polished version of you. They need the real one.

Letter 1: Before I knew you

DATE I AM WRITING THIS: _____

This is the version of me from before you arrived.

Before you, I was:

The thing I loved most about my life before you was:

The thing I was hoping for, in the months before you:

If I could tell that version of myself one thing now, knowing what came after, it would be:

Letter 2: The day I found out

DATE I FOUND OUT: _____

WHERE I WAS: _____

WHO I WAS WITH: _____

I knew because:

The first feeling, before I could name it, was:

The first person I told was:

What they said back:

The thing I want you to know, about the moment I found out you existed:

A note to you, written as if you were already old enough to read it:

Letter 3: The first appointment

DATE OF THE FIRST APPOINTMENT: _____

WHO WENT WITH ME: _____

WHAT THEY DID:

THE FIRST TIME I HEARD YOUR HEARTBEAT (or saw you on a screen)

The date: _____

What it sounded like: _____

What it looked like: _____

How I felt, walking out of that appointment:

What I want you to know about that day:

Letter 4: Telling people about you

DATE WE SHARED THE NEWS WIDELY: _____

THE PEOPLE I TOLD FIRST, ONE BY ONE

1. _____

Their reaction: _____

2. _____

Their reaction: _____

3. _____

Their reaction: _____

THE REACTION THAT MEANT THE MOST

Who: _____

What they said or did:

THE REACTION THAT SURPRISED ME

THE PERSON I WAS THE MOST AFRAID TO TELL

Why: _____

How it actually went: _____

HOW WE TOLD THE WORLD (if at all)

WHAT I WANT YOU TO KNOW ABOUT HOW LOVED YOU WERE, BEFORE YOU
EVEN ARRIVED

Letter 5: The first time I felt you

DATE OF THE FIRST KICK (or what I thought might be):

WEEK OF PREGNANCY:

WHERE I WAS:

WHAT IT FELT LIKE (try to describe it before you forget):

WHEN YOU MOVED THE MOST

Time of day:

What I had eaten or done:

THE THING YOU DID IN MY BODY THAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

WHEN YOUR OTHER PARENT (or sibling, or friend) FELT YOU FROM THE
OUTSIDE FOR THE FIRST TIME

Who:

Date:

Their reaction:

A LINE I WANT TO SAY TO YOU NOW, ABOUT WHEN YOU WERE STILL JUST A
FEELING IN MY BELLY

Letter 6: Your name, the story

NAMES WE CONSIDERED

WHY WE LANDED ON THE NAME WE DID (or are leaning toward)

WHAT THE NAME MEANS

WHO ELSE HAS THIS NAME (family, friends, people we admire)

A NOTE TO YOU, ABOUT YOUR NAME

The first time we said your name out loud as belonging to you:

What we hope it gives you:

What we know it cannot give you:

ALTERNATE NAMES THAT ALMOST WERE

(In the future, you might want to know what you almost were called. Here you go.)

Letter 7: What our family is like, before you arrive

THE PEOPLE WHO ARE ALREADY HERE

Your other parent (if applicable):

Their name: _____

What I love about them:

Your siblings (if any):

Your grandparents (if alive or known):

The people we have chosen as your "extra family":

OUR HOUSE / WHERE WE LIVE

What it smells like: _____

What you can hear from the front porch:

OUR PETS (if any)

OUR FOOD (the food I am eating while pregnant with you)

The thing I make the most: _____

The thing I order takeout most: _____

The thing I have been craving: _____

OUR HABITS (the ones you will inherit, for better and worse)

Letter 8: What the world is like in this year

THE YEAR I AM PREGNANT WITH YOU: _____

THE SONG THAT IS EVERYWHERE RIGHT NOW

THE MOVIE EVERYONE IS TALKING ABOUT

THE BOOK I AM READING THIS WEEK

WHAT THE NEWS IS LOUDEST ABOUT

WHAT IS HAPPENING IN OUR CITY / TOWN

A TECHNOLOGY THAT IS NEW

WHAT THINGS COST (so you can compare, years later)

A gallon of milk: \$____

A coffee: \$____

A movie ticket: \$____

A car (rough): \$____

Our rent or mortgage: \$____

WHAT I HOPE THE WORLD HAS, BY THE TIME YOU CAN READ THIS

WHAT I HOPE THE WORLD NO LONGER HAS, BY THE TIME YOU CAN READ THIS

Letter 9: What your other parent is like

For the version of this journal where there is a partner.

If there is not, skip to the next letter. Or use this page to write about the people who are stepping into the parenting role for you in other ways: a co-parent, a chosen family, a community.

THE OTHER PARENT'S NAME: _____

HOW WE MET: _____

HOW LONG WE HAVE BEEN TOGETHER: _____

THE FIRST TIME I KNEW THEY WOULD BE GOOD WITH A KID

WHAT THEY HAVE DONE DURING PREGNANCY THAT HAS MADE ME LOVE THEM MORE

WHAT I AM MOST EXCITED TO SEE THEM DO AS YOUR PARENT

THE THING ABOUT THEM I WANT YOU TO REMEMBER

A PICTURE OF THEM (description) FROM THIS WEEK

A WORD ABOUT YOUR OTHER PARENT, FOR YOU, FROM ME

Letter 10: What I want you to know about your grandparents

YOUR GRANDPARENTS, AS THEY ARE NOW (in pregnancy)

On my side:

Name: _____

What they are like:

Name: _____

What they are like:

On your other parent's side:

Name: _____

What they are like:

Name: _____

What they are like:

GRANDPARENTS WHO ARE NOT HERE (if applicable)

What I want you to know about them:

THE STORY I WANT TO REMEMBER TO TELL YOU, ABOUT ONE OF YOUR
GRANDPARENTS, WHEN YOU ARE OLD ENOUGH

Who: _____

The story:

Letter 11: The last week before you

DATE OF THIS LETTER: _____

WEEK OF PREGNANCY: _____

WHAT THIS WEEK FEELS LIKE

WHAT I DID TODAY THAT I MAY NOT DO AGAIN FOR A WHILE

THE QUIET MOMENT THIS WEEK I WANT TO REMEMBER

THE FEAR I AM HOLDING

THE JOY I AM HOLDING

A NOTE TO YOU, FROM THE LAST WEEK YOU WILL BE INSIDE ME

Letter 12: The night before you came

DATE OF THIS LETTER: _____

WHAT TONIGHT FEELS LIKE

WHO IS WITH ME

WHAT WE HAVE PACKED

THE LAST THING I DID BEFORE I PUT THIS DOWN AND TRIED TO SLEEP

A NOTE TO YOU FROM THE NIGHT BEFORE WE MEET

I do not know yet:

- When I will see your face
- What you will look like
- What your voice sounds like
- How the birth will go

I do know:

- I love you already.
- I am ready, even when I do not feel ready.
- We made it together.

THE LAST LINE I WANT TO WRITE BEFORE TOMORROW

Letter 13: The first time I saw you

DATE YOU WERE BORN: _____

TIME: _____

WEIGHT + LENGTH: _____

THE FIRST THING I NOTICED ABOUT YOUR FACE

THE FIRST THING I SAID TO YOU

WHO HELD YOU FIRST AFTER ME

WHAT THE ROOM SMELLED LIKE

THE THING I WANT TO REMEMBER ABOUT THE FIRST HOUR

WHAT MY BODY DID THAT I AM PROUD OF

WHAT MY PARTNER (or support person) DID THAT I AM GRATEFUL FOR

WHAT I WANT TO TELL THE VERSION OF ME WHO WROTE LETTER 1, NOW THAT
YOU ARE HERE

A LAST LETTER, TO YOU, ON THE DAY YOU WERE BORN

Things I want to remember to tell you

A running list. Add to it across pregnancy. Add to it after.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

More things to remember

21. _____

22. _____

23. _____

24. _____

25. _____

26. _____

27. _____

28. _____

29. _____

30. _____

31. _____

32. _____

33. _____

34. _____

35. _____

36. _____

37. _____

38. _____

39. _____

40. _____

Pocket page: your first ultrasound

Print this page on cardstock if you can. Cut a slit. Tuck the picture in. Or paste it on.

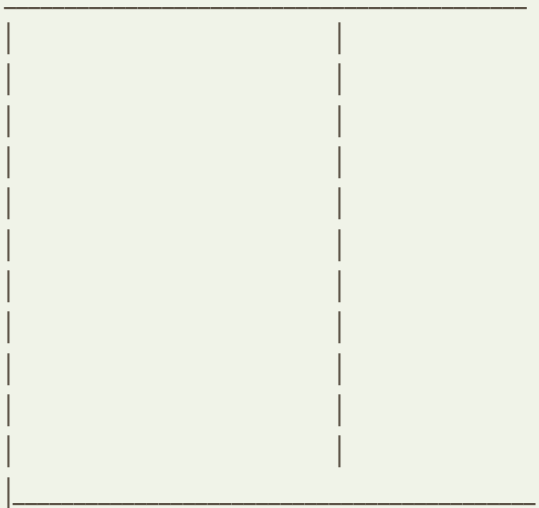
DATE OF THE PHOTO: _____

WEEK OF PREGNANCY: _____

WHO WAS WITH ME: _____

A NOTE I WROTE BENEATH THE PHOTO, FOR YOU

(SPACE FOR THE PHOTO TO BE PASTED OR TUCKED IN BELOW.)



Pocket page: your hospital bracelet

The little plastic ID band they put on the baby's wrist. The one on your wrist. Keep them here.

DATE OF YOUR BIRTH: _____

WHAT THE BAND SAYS: _____

WHERE YOU WERE BORN: _____

(SPACE FOR THE BRACELET BELOW. Tuck it through a slit you cut, or
paste it flat.)

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A NOTE NEXT TO THE BRACELET, FOR YOU TO READ ONE DAY:

A final note

You wrote to a person you had not met yet.

For most of human history, the version of yourself who was pregnant with the version of yourself who is now your child has been lost. You did not let that happen to you. You wrote it down.

Whatever the kid grows up to do, whether they read this journal at twelve or at thirty or never, whether they laugh at it or cry over it, the act of having written it is itself part of the story. They will know, on some level, that you wrote to them before they could refuse the gesture.

The journal closes here. The conversation continues for the rest of your life together.

We are so glad they are here.

With care, Maya



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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